# My Process Working with AI Tools

I started by reaching out to the relevant people in my life for help. Since this was the first time I'd taken on a project of this scope, I figured it was best to consult with people who have experience in both programming and AI-augmented development.

Once I had gathered enough information to get going, I kicked things off by giving Claude the assignment details: the concept (as presented in the Moveo Coding Task file), my understanding of the pages and features, plus the tech options the hiring team provided. For each option, I asked Claude to explain the differences and the pros and cons - for example, a comparison between SQLite, PostgreSQL, and MongoDB - and then to give its recommendation based on the project's needs and scope. I always made sure to ask for the reasoning behind each recommendation, since I want to understand *why* the AI is suggesting something rather than just take it at face value. At the end of the day, I know my needs better than the AI does, and it's on me to review its output and decide what actually fits.

With the tech stack settled, I moved on to architecture. I compared three options and went with the one that fit the project best (backend/frontend). From there, I put together the PROJECT_BRIEF.md file, which lays out every detail of the project - features, pages, architecture, folder structure, tech stack, and so on - and which I then used to define an order of implementation.

Next, I took the brief and the implementation order and, using Plan mode in Claude Code, created a separate plan for each phase, one at a time. Each plan was written only after the previous phase was fully implemented, so it could take the actual state of the project into account.

For the design, I used Claude Design by Anthropic. I drove the decisions on colors, layout, and component visualization, giving specific instructions about what I wanted and where. Those decisions were grounded in market research: I asked Gemini for the top 5 crypto investor dashboards and what sets each apart, then went into each one and played around to get a feel for how they look and behave.

As with any programming project, there were surprises. CryptoPanic, for instance, no longer has a free tier, so I researched and picked an alternative that fit the project's needs.

Midway through, I had a lot of ideas for improvements, changes, and UX additions. Being time-limited, I had to choose what to implement and what to set aside. I started by shipping a working v1 and iterating on it as time allowed, staying focused on the Must-Haves before touching the Nice-To-Haves - a working "basic" product that meets all the requirements beats a hypothetical "perfect" one.